Mersey Rivers Trust

Strategy, Monitoring & the River Bollin

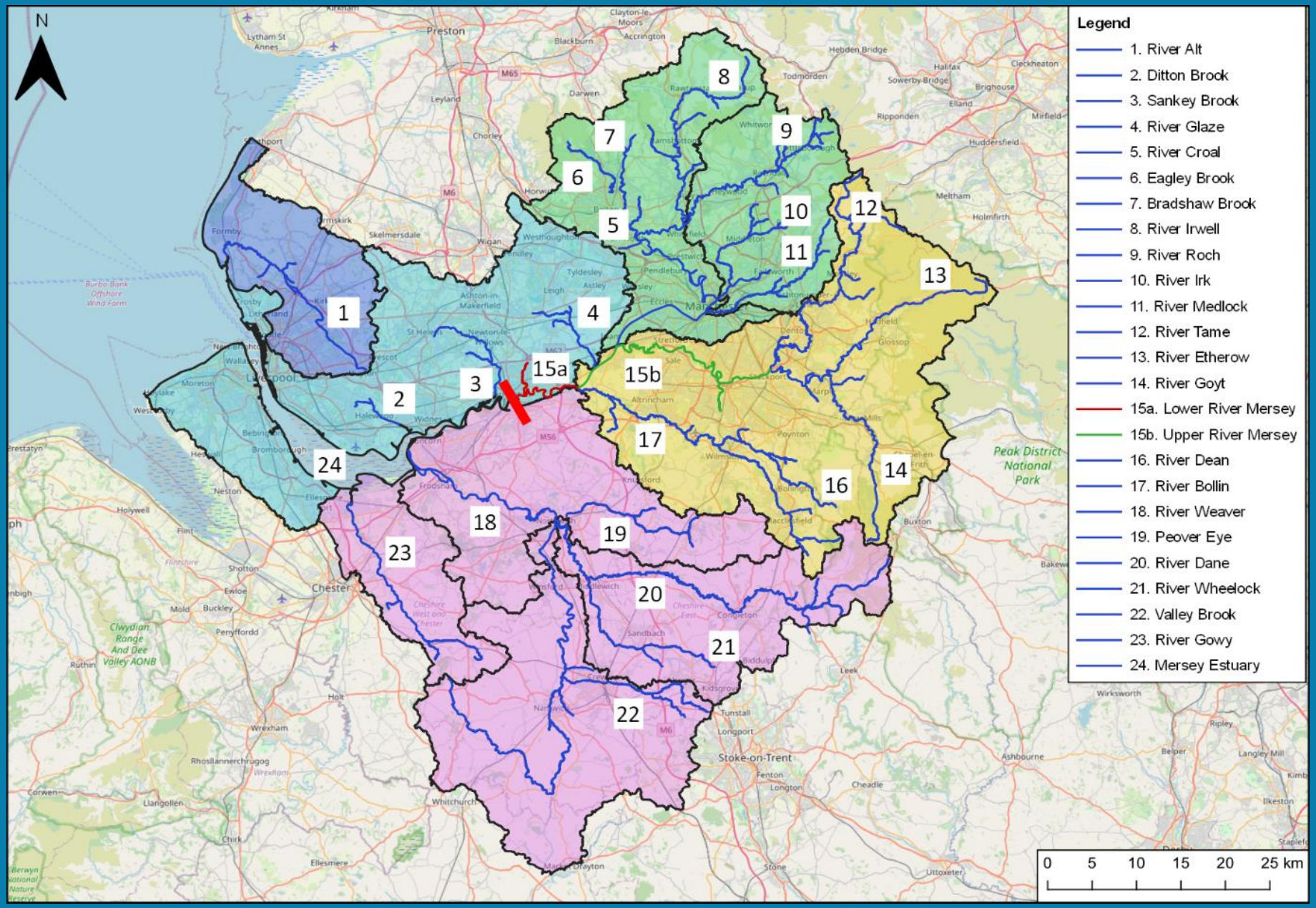
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BEACON
Bollin Environmental

The Rivers Trust

Catchment Based Approach
Partnerships for Action

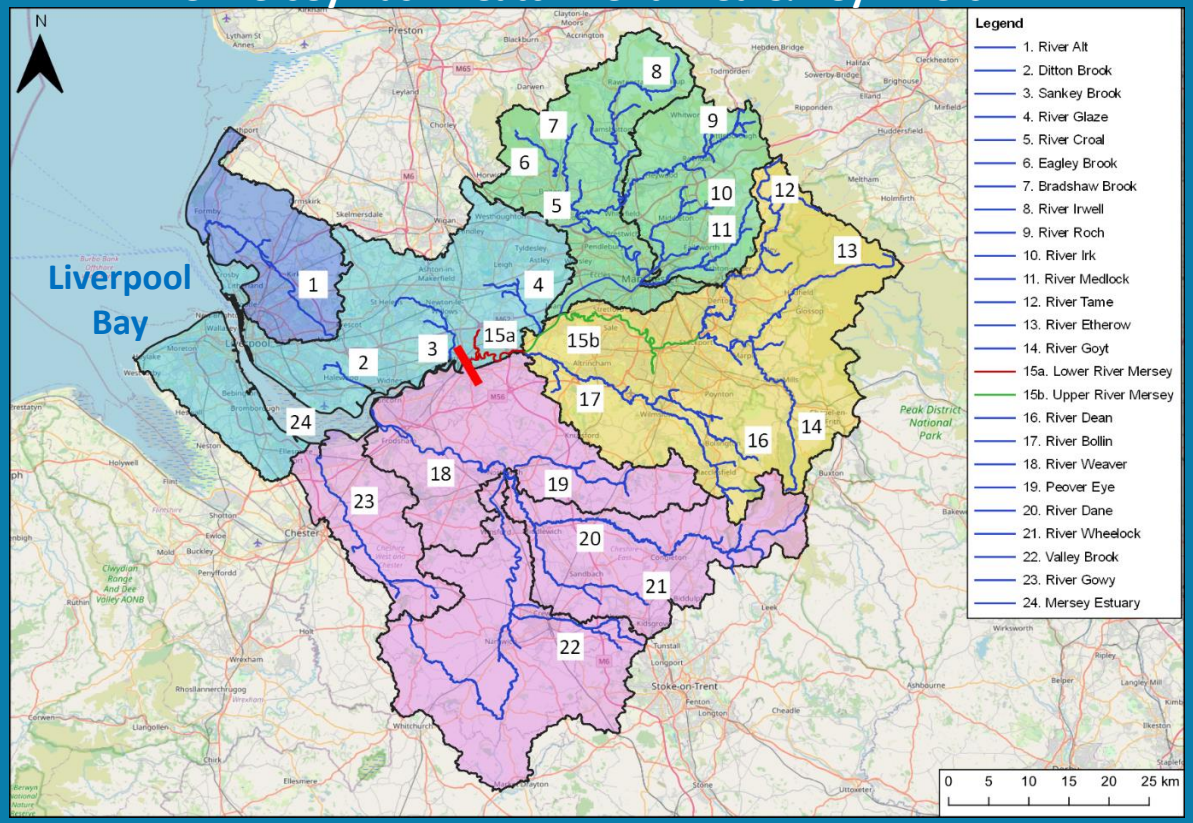
Mersey River Basin



The Mersey Basin

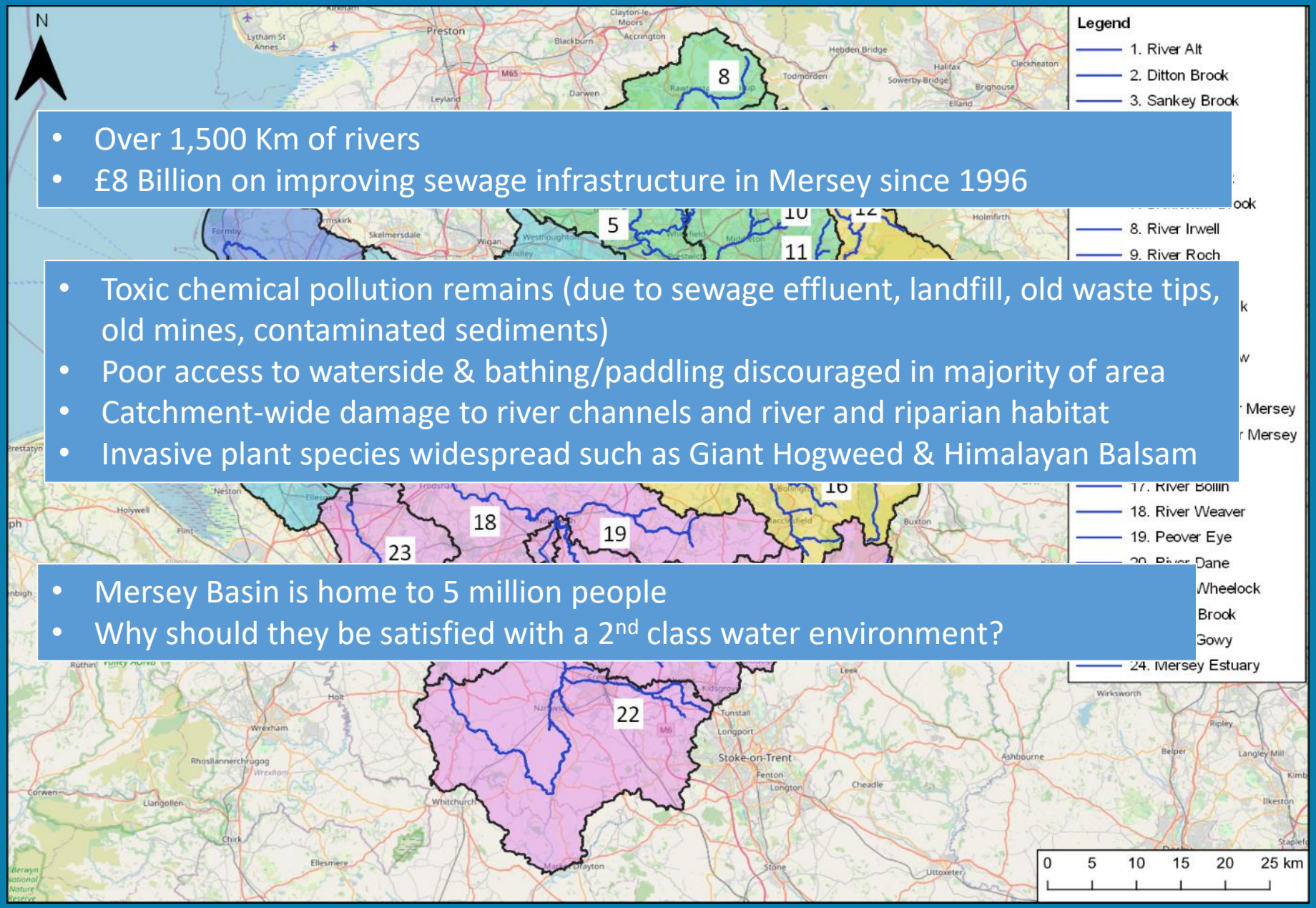
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The Mersey Basin: Catchment Area & Key Rivers



- 5 million population across Cheshire, Merseyside and Greater Manchester
- 27 main tributary rivers, plus Manchester Ship Canal
- 4,000 km^2 catchment area
- Most water bodies are not in good ecological condition
- Legacy of 200+ years of industrialisation and urbanisation particularly in City Regions of Manchester and Liverpool

Mersey Basin Challenges



- Over 1,500 Km of rivers
- £8 Billion on improving sewage infrastructure in Mersey since 1996

- Toxic chemical pollution remains (due to sewage effluent, landfill, old waste tips, old mines, contaminated sediments)
- Poor access to waterside & bathing/paddling discouraged in majority of area
- Catchment-wide damage to river channels and river and riparian habitat
- Invasive plant species widespread such as Giant Hogweed & Himalayan Balsam

- Mersey Basin is home to 5 million people
- Why should they be satisfied with a 2nd class water environment?

Our Strategic Ambition

To restore our rivers as near to its pre-industrial state as is feasibly possible by 2050, with maximum benefits for our community based on their ambition for the future of their local environment.

Fisheries

- Restore our Fish Populations

Water Quality

- Reverse the impacts of poor Water Quality, both current & historic

Recreation & Access

- Maximise our rivers potential for Recreation & Access

Habitat & Nature Recovery

- Optimise the Conservation & Wildlife value of our catchments whilst eradicating troublesome invasive species

Water Quality Challenges

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Habitat & Nature Recovery

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Delivering Nature-Based Solutions

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Green Recovery Challenge Fund

Department for Environment Food & Rural Affairs

The National Lottery Heritage Fund

Environment Agency

NATURAL ENGLAND

Delivering River Habitat Enhancements

Mersey Rivers Trust














Monitoring, Data and Evidence

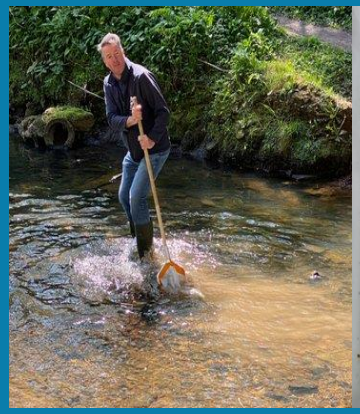
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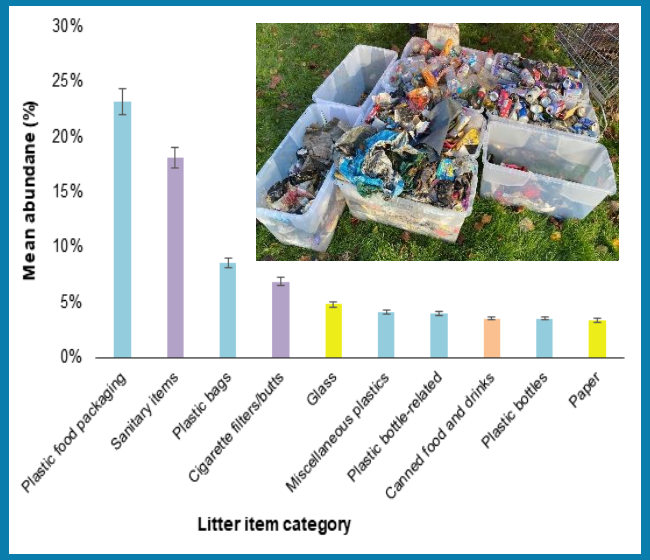




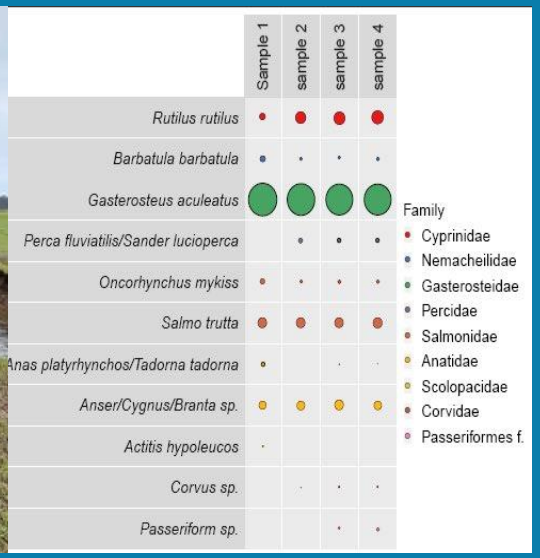


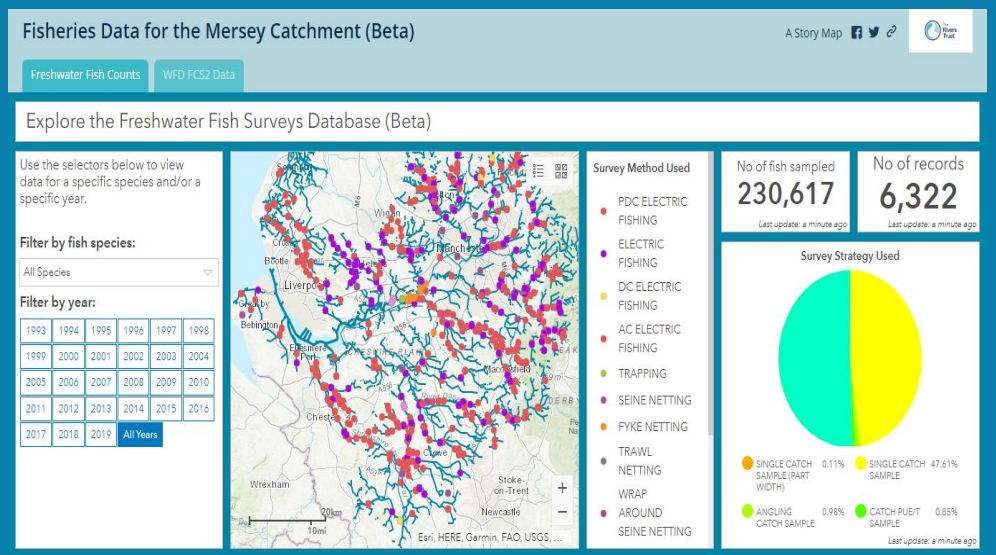


Date	14/01/2018		9/2/2018		21/04/2018	
Target Groups:	Category (A - D)	Estimated Number *	Category (A - D)	Estimated Number *	Category (A - D)	Estimated Number *
Cased caddis	A	1	A	1	A	1
Caseless caddis	A	2			A	2
Mayfly (Ephemeridae)					A	1
BWO (Ephemerellidae)						0
Flat bodied (Heptageniidae)	A	1	B	10	B	50
Olives (Baetidae)	A	6	B	10	B	40
Stoneflies					A	2
Freshwater shrimp						0









Mersey Rivers Trust Monitoring Activities

- Water quality monitoring – especially key indicators of river pollution (ammonia, phosphorus, nitrates, conductivity)
- Ecological monitoring – particularly river invertebrates and fish
- River corridor fauna and flora – including invasive plant species, otter, water vole and bats
- River habitat surveys – river channel & riparian habitat

Citizen Science Monitoring

Mersey Rivers Trust



















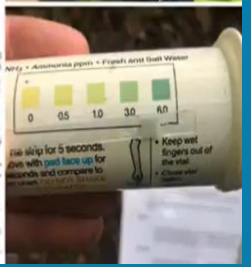


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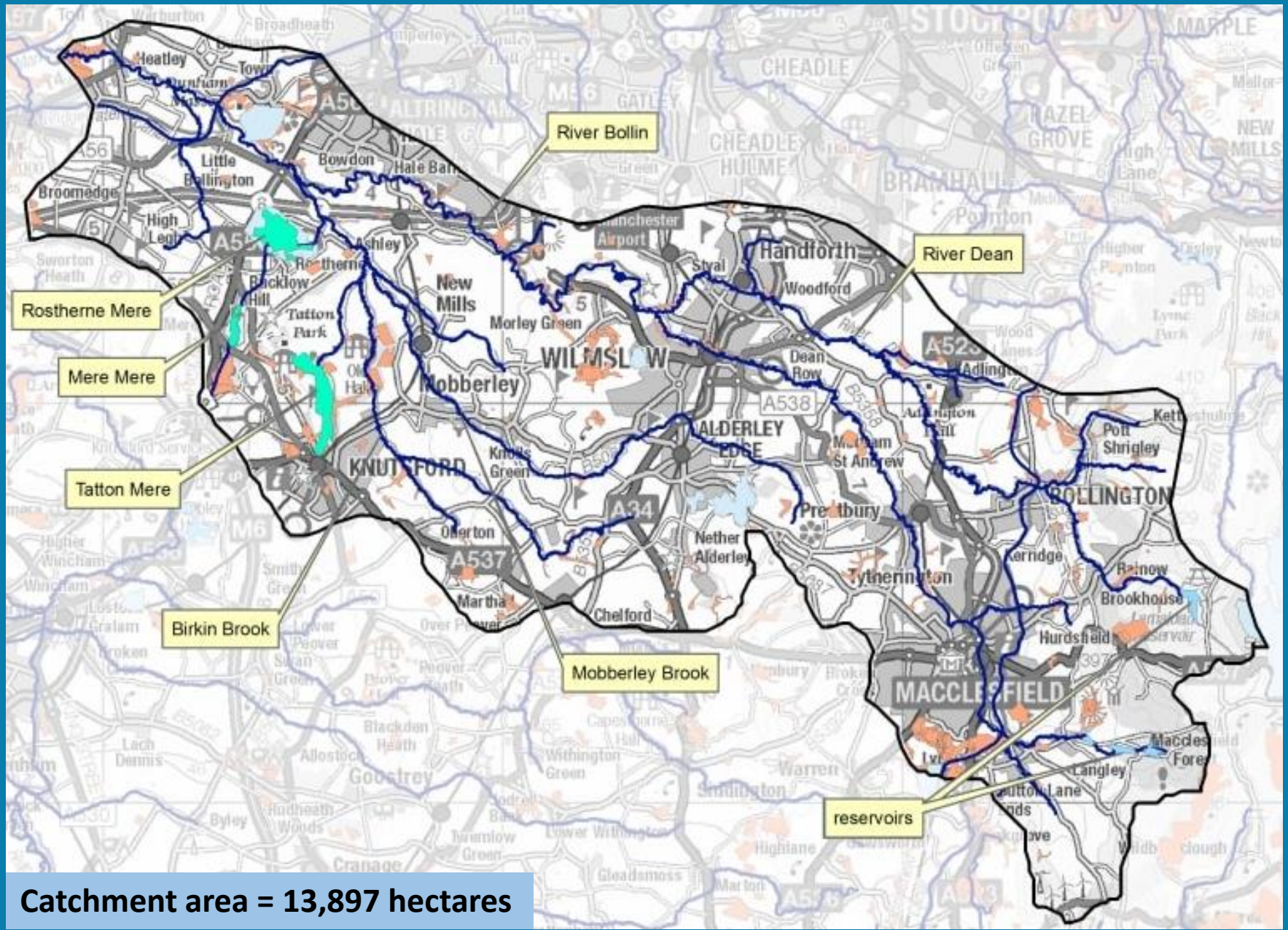






River Bollin

Mersey Rivers Trust



Catchment area = 13,897 hectares

River Bollin

- Important river catchment but not in good ecological condition

- Various internationally important wetlands and nationally important nature reserves and Sites of Special
- Scientific Interest

- Environmentally important but degraded lowland peat habitats, meres, mosses and mires

- River Bollin has a fragile recovering salmon population but adverse water quality, poor habitat & barriers to migration are impeding recovery







River Bollin

- Key habitat challenges include:
  - Artificial or heavily modified river channels
  - Culverted reaches of river
  - Legacy industrial weirs
  - Transport impacts: road, rail, airport
  - Legacy of peat extraction industry













River Bollin

- Key water quality challenges include:
  - Agricultural diffuse pollution and erosion impact, especially from dairy farming
  - Leachate from former landfill and waste disposal sites
  - Industrial pollution from chemicals used or stored near the river
  - Intermittent combined sewer overflows
- No continuous monitoring of river water quality in the catchment
- Limited “spot” sampling of water quality









River Bollin:

Recent Industrial Pollution Events

England | Local News | Manchester

River Bollin pollutant kills more than 100 fish

27 February 2023





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News › Greater Manchester News

Firefighters tackle major blaze as residents are told to shut windows and doors

Plumes of smoke could be seen for miles around

By Paul Britton Reporter UPDATED 13:39, 30 JUN 2024

Bookmark



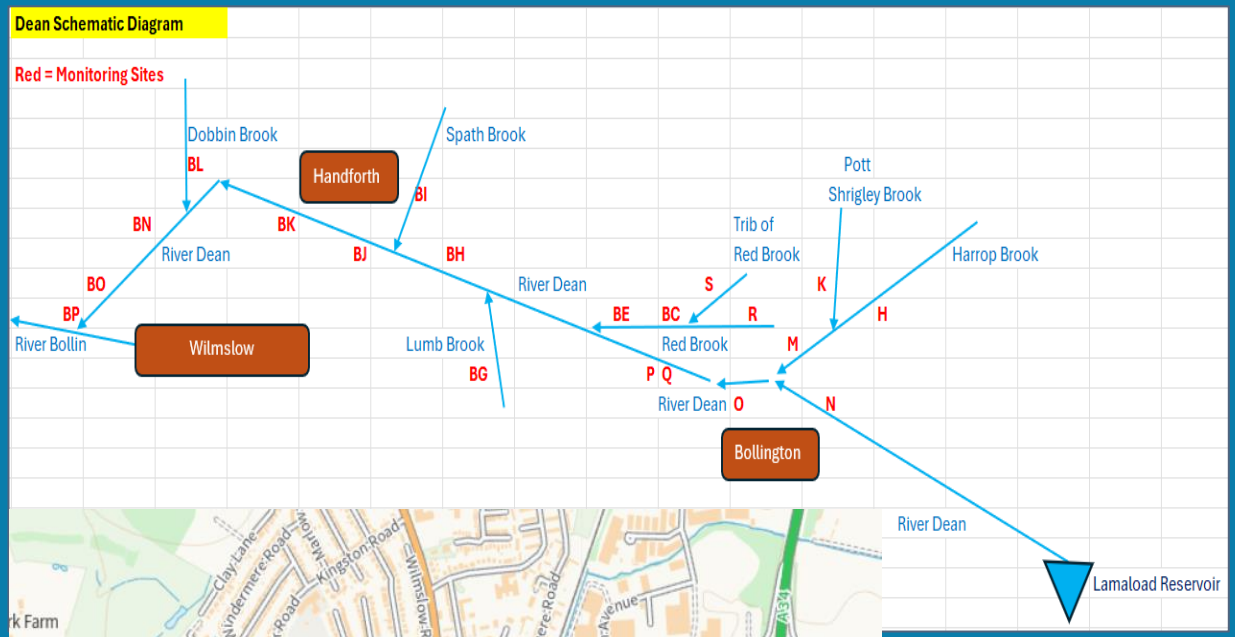




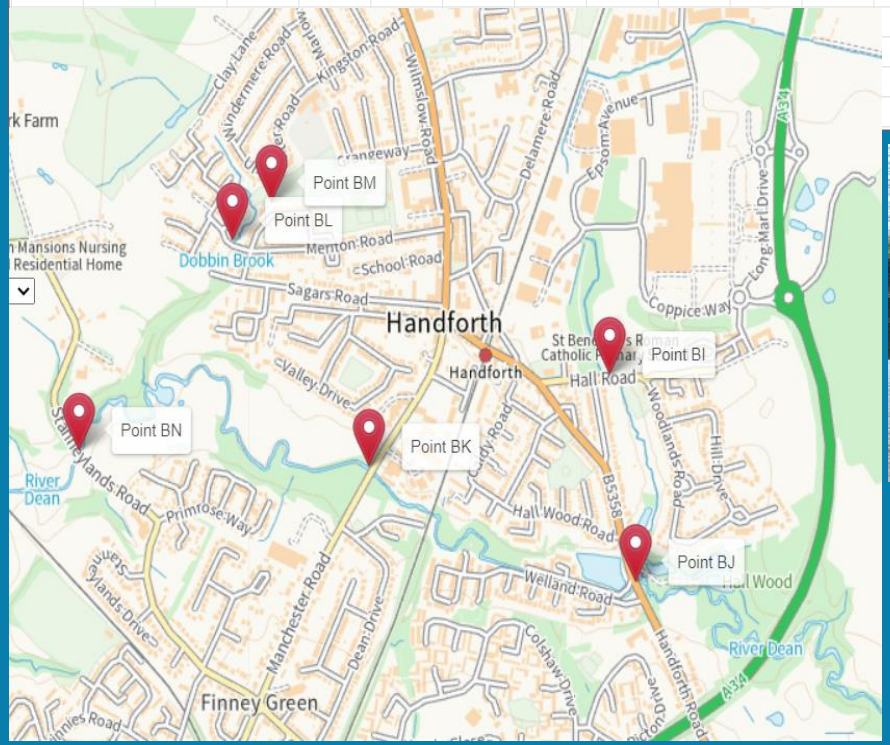
- 2 x 1000l IBC of UN1791- Hypochlorite
- 5 X 1000l IBC of UN1824- Sodium Hydroxide Solution
- 1 X 1000l IBC of Spectrum XD3899
- 1 x 1000l IBC of Grain Neutral Spirit @ 60% (contains Ethanol UN 1170)
- 2 x 1000l IBC UN1824- Sodium Hydroxide
- 8 x 25l of UN1719 Caustic Alkaline Liquid (potassium hydroxide and metasilicates)
- 1 x 1000l IBC of UN2031- Nitric Acid
- 8 x 25l of UN1719- Caustic Alkaline Liquid. (Sodium Hydroxide & Hypochlorite)
- 3 x 1000l IBC of UN3265- Corrosive liquid. (acidic & organic, maleic acid copolymer)
- 4 x 25kg- UN3082- Acticide MBS2550 – (Environmentally hazardous substance)
- 10 x 25kg UN1760- Acticide OTW8 – (Environmentally hazardous substance)
- 1 x 1000l IBC UN1760 Acticide CF (Ronseal)
- 1 X 1000l IBC of Spectrum PR 3681- Corrosive and acidic.
- 1 x 1000l IBC of UN1791 Spectrum XD1415
- 1 x 1000l of Spectrum NT3757

Bollin Monitoring Programme

Mersey Rivers Trust









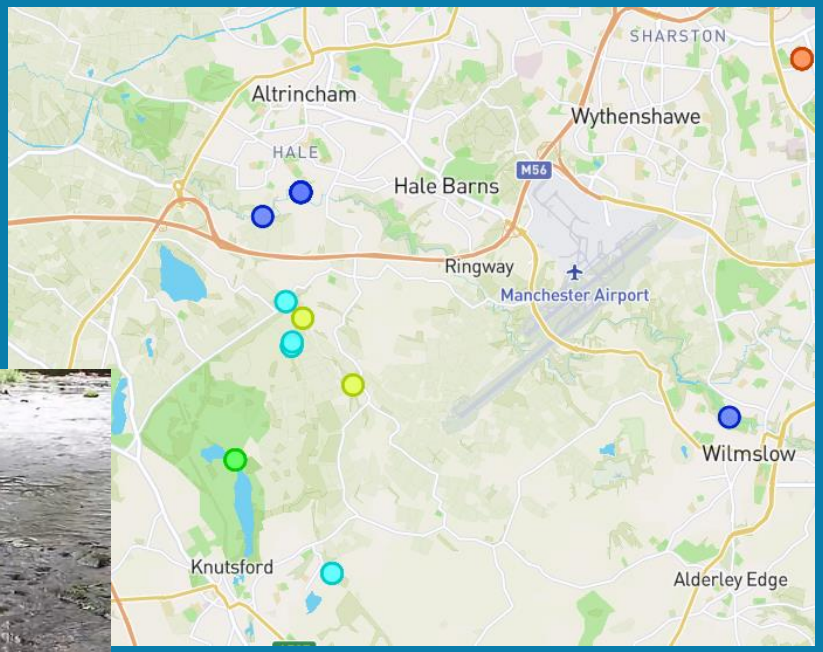




Bollin Monitoring Programme

Mersey Rivers Trust

The Riverfly Partnership







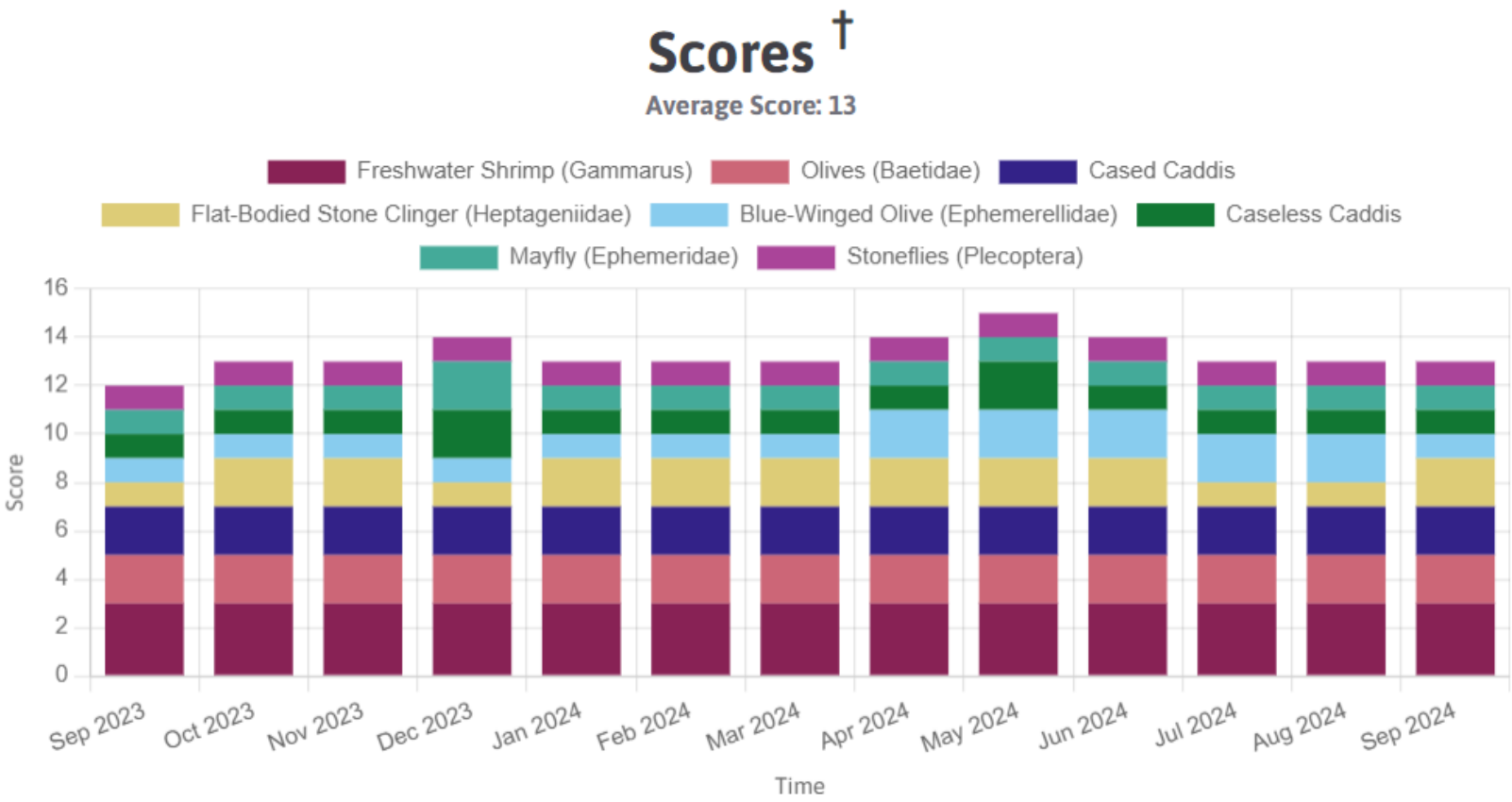






Riverfly Methodology as Pollution Indicator

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visit riverfly.org for more details

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Questions and Discussion

Thank You

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